



The Suffixes -ful and -less

I can add -ful or -less to make a new word.

Today I am learning to:

- ☐ understand what -ful and -less mean
- ☐ add -ful and -less to base words
- ☐ read and use new words
- ☐ use the words in sentences

1 Learn the Rule

The suffix **-ful** means **full of or having**.

The suffix **-less** means **without or not having**.

When we add a suffix to a base word, we make a new word with a different meaning.

-ful = full of, having

-less = without, not having



cheerful
full of cheer



cheerless
without cheer



hopeful
full of hope



hopeless
without hope



careful
full of care



careless
without care

2 Add -ful or -less

Write the new word.

1. hope hope _____



2. care care _____



3. help help _____



4. harm harm _____



5. thank thank _____



6. point point _____



7. use use _____



8. home home _____



3 Match the Meaning

Draw a line to match each word with its meaning.

helpful	●	●	without a purpose
harmless	●	●	without a home
careful	●	●	full of thanks
pointless	●	●	full of care
thankful	●	●	without harm
homeless	●	●	full of help

4 Choose the Correct Word

Tick (✓) the word that makes sense.

- | | | | |
|-----------------|-----------------------------------|------------------------------------|------------------|
| 1. We must be | ☐ careful | ☐ careless | on the road. |
| 2. She felt | ☐ hopeful | ☐ hopeless | before the test. |
| 3. It was a | ☐ helpful | ☐ helpless | idea. |
| 4. Please be | ☐ thankful | ☐ thankless | for your family. |
| 5. The bag was | ☐ useful | ☐ useless | to him. |
| 6. They found a | ☐ harmless | ☐ harmful | insect. |

5 Use the Words

Write a sentence for each picture using a word with **-ful** or **-less**.

1. _____

2. _____

3. _____

Word Bank

careful cheerful helpful
hopeless harmless pointless



Challenge

Choose a base word of your own. Add **-ful** or **-less** and write a sentence with the new word.

Suffixes help us
make new words
with new meanings!

